Pearson Edexcel GCSE (9–1)

Thursday 11 June 2026
Morning (Time: 1 hour 30 minutes)

PAPER REFERENCE
1HI0/33

History

Paper 3: Modern depth study

Option 33: Conflict at Home and Abroad: the USA, 1954–75

Sources/Interpretations Booklet

Do not return this Booklet with the question paper.

Sources/Interpretations for use with Section B.
This booklet contains Source B, Source C, Interpretation 1 and Interpretation 2 for use with Question 3 on the question paper.

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Sources/Interpretations for use with Section B.

Sources for use with Questions 3(a) and 3(c).

Source B

Source B: From classified US military intelligence assessments on Operation Rolling Thunder, compiled in 1966 and declassified in 1993.
March 1966: Despite intensive air operations against North Vietnam, communist forces have successfully increased the flow of personnel and material into the South. Hanoi remains committed to supporting the insurgency, and air strikes have failed to significantly impede their supply lines. September 1966: Air operations targeting transportation corridors have intensified. Nevertheless, we see no evidence of a major disruption in the flow of logistics to southern insurgents, and the strikes have not diminished the adversary's resolve.

Source C

Source C: From a broadcast interview with a US Army veteran in 1981, recalling his service in Vietnam during 1971–72.
Morale in our unit decayed steadily. Substance abuse was rampant, and interpersonal conflicts were common. Relations with officers were tense; we had one incompetent commander who panicked under fire. Ultimately, a soldier assassinated him by throwing a fragmentation grenade into his quarters. No investigation followed because most felt it was warranted. It felt like we were fighting ourselves as much as the enemy.

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Interpretations for use with Section B.

Interpretations for use with Questions 3(b), 3(c) and 3(d).

Interpretation 1

Interpretation 1: From a modern historical study.
US planners believed that sustained bombing would force Hanoi to abandon the conflict. However, the air campaign failed to halt the flow of troops and supplies to the South. Vietnamese repair crews quickly reconstructed damaged infrastructure or utilized alternative routes. Consequently, the reliance on air power was insufficient to break the communist insurgency's logistics.

Interpretation 2

Interpretation 2: From a different historical perspective.
While early US forces consisted largely of motivated volunteers, the growing reliance on conscription altered the army's composition. Many draftees resented their service and questioned the war's purpose. This decline in discipline manifested in widespread drug abuse, insubordination, and instances of violence against officers. High desertion rates reflected a broader loss of belief in the military mission.

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